

WEAR AT SUPPORTS

EDGE, FULL WIDTH, OR BUILDUP?

A sharp signal at one edge of a support can be real edge wear, or something sitting there.

KEY IDEA

Wear happens where the tube touches the support. It often spans the full support width. A signal clearly outside the support is probably not wear.

1 WHERE WEAR HAPPENS

- Within the support's thickness, where the tube makes contact.
- At plates and baffles it often runs the full width of the support.
- Heavier at one edge if the tube leans or pivots in the hole (edge wear).
- AVBs are thin, so their wear is short and right at the bar.

2 WEAR OR BUILDUP?

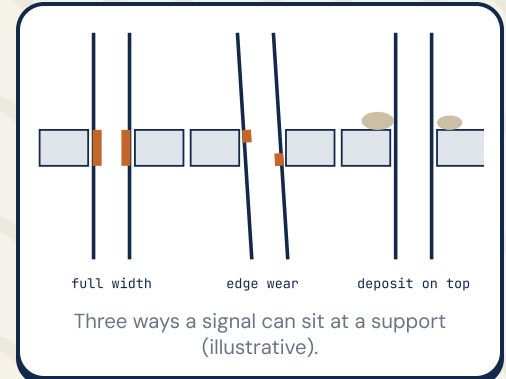
- Absolute channel: wall loss swings one way, added material the other.
- Trace and lobes on the mix should match your wall-loss cal flaws.
- Outside material gets stronger as frequency drops. Wear also shows on high frequencies.
- Magnetic buildup is very strong on the very low frequency.

3 LOCATION CLUES

- In vertical units, deposits settle on the top of support plates.
- Edge wear tends to be on the same edge at several supports if the tube leans.
- A cluster of tubes at the same height suggests a loose part or deposit pile.
- A loose part can also cause wear. Many sites code it PLP.

4 HISTORY AND CONFIRMATION

- Wear grows slowly and stays put between inspections.
- Deposits and loose parts can appear, move, or disappear.
- A rotating probe (+Point or RPC) can confirm what it is.
- A suspected loose part may justify a secondary-side visual.



BEFORE YOU CALL WAR

- › Wall-loss direction confirmed
- › Lines up with the support location
- › Not explained by buildup or a loose part

QUICK TIPS

Don't size it as WAR until wall loss is confirmed.

Check the same support on neighboring tubes.

A sharp signal at the edge is a fair reason to escalate.